credits and grants to developing countries for a wide array of purposes that include investments in education, health, public administration, infrastructure, financial and private sector development, agriculture and environmental and natural resource management.

To become a member of the Bank, under the IBRD Articles of Agreement, a country must first join the International Monetary Fund (IMF). Membership in IDA, IFC and MIGA are conditional on membership in IBRD. Member countries govern the World Bank Group through the Boards of Governors and the Boards of Executive Directors. These bodies make all major decisions for the organizations.

Total member countries in each institution

The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)	**188**
The International Development Association (IDA)	**172**
The International Finance Corporation (IFC)	**184**
The Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA)	**177**
The International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID)	**147**

India joined the World Bank in 1944, and therefore, is one of the oldest members. It is the World Bank's largest single borrower, in market-based loans from the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) and development credits from the International Development Association. Andhra Pradesh was the first state to benefit from of state-focused lending and Uttar Pradesh the Second in 2000.

However, the World Bank activities like the IMF have invited criticisms from the developing world. There is a hegemony of developed world, and the transactions lack transparency and democracy. The Structural Adjustment Programmes have created hurdles for the poor developing countries, and have added to their dismal economic performance. The 1980s witnessed the sub-Saharan countries facing tremendous crisis due to the Structural Adjustment Programmes. There is strong demand for democratization of the institutions dominating the international political economy.